- How to use `DataAnnotations` attributes to describe the data you expect
- How to validate your endpoint handler parameters

Validation in general is a big topic, one that you'll need to consider in every app you build. Minimal APIs don't include validation by default, instead opting to provide nonprescriptive hooks via the filters you learned about in chapter 5. This design gives you multiple options for adding validation to your app; be sure that you do add some!

## *7.10.1 The need for validation*

Data can come from many sources in your web application. You could load data from files, read it from a database, or accept values that are sent in a request. Although you may be inclined to trust that the data already on your server is valid (though this assumption is sometimes dangerous!), you *definitely* shouldn't trust the data sent as part of a request.

**TIP** You can read more about the goals of validation, implementation approaches, and potential attacks at http://mng.bz/gBxE.

You should validate your endpoint handler parameters before you use them to do anything that touches your domain, anything that touches your infrastructure, or anything that could leak information to an attacker. Note that this warning is intentionally vague, as there's no defined point in minimal APIs where validation should occur. I advise that you do it as soon as possible in the minimal API filter pipeline.

*Always validate data provided by users before you use it in your methods*. You have no idea what the browser may have sent you. The classic example